Kora free starter project pack

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Kora Workplace Supply Ltd is a fictional Nigerian supplier.

This pack contains seven related tables, 29,066 records and two project briefs, it is free to use for learning. In this pack you will:

- Load a local database.
- Investigate two business questions.
- Explain what the evidence supports.

Load the database Understand the data Project 1 Project 2

Load Kora into a local database

Start with the extracted folder

Download the learner ZIP and extract it. On Windows choose Extract All; on Mac open the ZIP to extract it. Open Kora-2025-only.pdf in your browser. Keep your own queries and reports in a separate working folder.

Choose one database engine. The same seven tables are provided in both routes. The CSVs are optional for Excel or Power BI; the SQL loaders already contain all data, so you do not need to import seven CSVs manually.

Route A SQLite on Mac or Windows

> If you already have SQLite on your windows, you can skip to number 2
>
> If you are already comfortable loading databases? Open Database/SQLite/Kora_Starter.sqlite directly. It contains the same data but skips the import lesson.

1. Install DB Browser for SQLite from https://sqlitebrowser.org/dl/ and open the application. Choose the download for your operating system. SQLite runs locally; it does not require a separate database server or login.
2. Start with no database open. Choose File > Import > Database from SQL file.
3. Select Database/SQLite/01_Load_Kora_Starter.sql from the extracted pack. If asked whether to create a new database, choose Yes.
4. Save the new database in your working folder as My_Kora_Starter.sqlite. Use a new filename rather than the supplied preloaded copy.

5. Wait for the import to finish. If prompted to save, confirm; use Write Changes if enabled. The seven tables should appear under Database Structure.
6. In Execute SQL, run SELECT COUNT(*) AS orders_loaded FROM orders; using the execute button. Expect 6001.
7. Open Database/SQLite/02_Check_Load.sql in the SQL editor and run its statements. Compare counts to the table below. integrity_check should return ok; foreign_key_check should return no problem rows.
8. Close the application, reopen My_Kora_Starter.sqlite and repeat the count to confirm the file was saved. Now start Project 1.

Already comfortable loading databases? Open Database/SQLite/Kora_Starter.sqlite directly. It contains the same data but skips the import lesson.

Route B SQL Server on Windows

If you already have SQL Server on your windows, you can skip to number 3

1. Install the free **SQL Server Express** database engine from https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/sql-server/sql-server-downloads and keep the instance name shown by setup. Basic installation is suitable for a local learning instance. Use Windows Authentication for this route.
2. Install **SQL Server Management Studio** from https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/ssms/install/install . SSMS is the interface you will use to interact with your local database engine.
3. Open SSMS and connect to the local Database Engine using Windows Authentication and the instance name from setup. A named instance commonly looks like localhost\SQLEXPRESS; a default instance can use localhost. Use your actual instance name.
4. Open Database/SQL_Server/00_Create_Database.sql with File › Open › File. Run the whole file with Execute. Expect current_database = KoraStarter.
5. Open Database/SQL_Server/01_Load_Kora_Starter.sql and execute the whole file with no text selected. It creates the kora schema, all tables, relationships and data in KoraStarter. Expect Kora starter loaded successfully. It will stop if the kora schema already exists.
6. Run Database/SQL_Server/02_Check_Load.sql. Compare the results with the controls. Refresh Object Explorer › Databases › KoraStarter › Tables.
7. Open a new query connected to KoraStarter and run SELECT COUNT(*) AS orders_loaded FROM kora.orders; Expect 6001.

What a successful load looks like

- All seven tables exist.
- Orders has 6001 rows.
- Order dates range from 2025-01-01 to 2025-12-31.
- Sum net_order_value_ngn is 17713266033.00 NGN across all order statuses.
- Detailed controls are in Reference/Load_Control_Totals.json.

First query

SQLite: SELECT * FROM orders LIMIT 10;

SQL Server: SELECT TOP (10) * FROM kora.orders;

These show up to ten rows. Without ORDER BY, SQL does not promise which ten rows appear or their order. Add ORDER BY order_date, order_id for a repeatable display.

Common problems

- Tables already exist or the kora schema exists: the data may already be loaded. Run the count checks. For a new SQLite import, start a separate new file; do not import over the supplied database. For SQL Server, keep the loaded copy and use it rather than re-running the loader. No reset or deletion script is included.
- SQL Server cannot find the server: confirm the engine is installed and running and use the actual local instance name. SSMS alone is not the engine.
- A local SQL Server certificate is not trusted: confirm the host is your own local learning instance. SSMS has a Trust Server Certificate option for that local connection. Use validated certificates for remote services.
- GO or kora.orders causes an error in SQLite: that is the SQL Server file. Switch to the SQLite folder. SQLite tables here have no kora prefix.
- LIMIT causes an error in SQL Server: use the supplied SQL Server query file, which uses TOP. Do not mix the routes.
- A blank CSV date becomes 0 in a spreadsheet: blank means missing or not yet applicable, not a date of zero. The SQL loader preserves SQL NULL.
- SQLite says database is locked: close other tools using that same file, save or discard pending edits deliberately, and retry the read query.
- Counts differ: confirm you used this starter extract rather than the original 45-table simulation and did not filter the Browse Data view. Run COUNT(*) in SQL.

Use the data in Power BI or Excel

The CSV files can be imported directly for reporting. Keep IDs as text, parse dates as ISO year-month-day, and set NGN values to decimal numbers using a locale that recognises the decimal point. Do not append the CSVs to the database after loading the SQL file; that would try to load the data twice.

In Power BI, avoid blindly activating both Regions > Customers > Orders and Regions > Branches > Orders filter paths. Customer geography and branch geography represent different roles. Use separate role-playing region tables or one deliberate active path. Keep order_lines and deliveries as separate facts. Joining both raw tables on order_id duplicates values when an order has multiple lines and consignments.

For a direct SQL Server connection, choose Get Data > SQL Server, enter your local instance and KoraStarter, and select the kora tables. SQLite does not use the SQL Server connector; use the CSV route for an accessible starter reporting workflow.

Understand the data

Kora Workplace Supply Ltd supplies workplace technology, furniture and business supplies to fictional organisations in Nigeria. This free extract contains orders placed from 1 January to 31 December 2025, their order lines and associated consignments recorded through 31 December 2025. Values are NGN and order value excludes tax.

Table Details

- regions: one row per geographic region.
- branches: one row per distribution centre.
- customers: one row per customer in the source snapshot, including customers with no 2025 orders.
- products: one row per product in the source snapshot.
- orders: one row per order placed in 2025.
- order_lines: one row per product line within an order. Repeated product IDs are expected.
- deliveries: one row per delivery consignment attached to a selected order. Several consignments can belong to one order.

Join rules

Every table has an ID primary key.

A foreign key links a child to its parent.

Joins

- customers.customer_id to orders.customer_id;
- orders.order_id to order_lines.order_id;
- products.product_id to order_lines.product_id;
- orders.order_id to deliveries.order_id;
- Join branches on branch_id.

***Customer region and branch region may differ.

Joining orders to order_lines repeats each order for every line, COUNT(*) then counts lines, not orders.

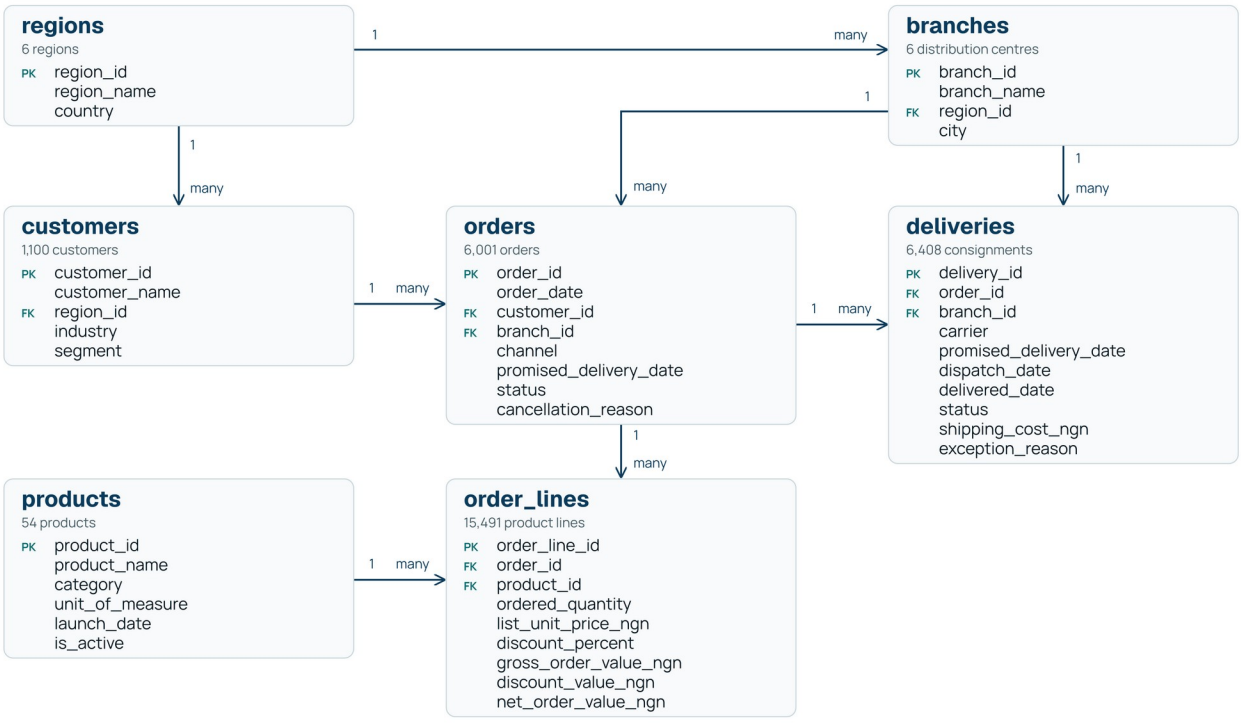
Joining order_lines and deliveries directly repeats both sets of measures. For a combined order summary, aggregate lines and deliveries independently to one row per order before joining.

What is deliberately outside the starter pack

Invoices, returns, payments, costs of goods, inventory quantities, delivery-line quantities, HR and finance ledgers are not included. You can investigate order demand and delivery service; you cannot calculate recognized revenue, gross profit, cash collection, order-fill quantity or a full company financial statement from this extract.

No anomalies have been added.

Database Schema



1 → many: one parent can have many children. PK: primary key. FK: foreign key.

Project 1: Sales demand and cancellations

The decision

Kora's Commercial Manager wants to know where the next quarter's account management attention should go. Orders are arriving, but how much demand survives cancellation, and where are discounts highest?

Recommend two priorities supported by evidence.

Your data

Use orders, order_lines, products and customers. You may add branches and regions when useful. The extract includes orders placed in 2025 and their related deliveries through 31 December 2025. Customer and product tables are snapshot reference lists, including customers with no orders in this extract.

Questions to answer

1. How many orders were placed each month? Show all order value, cancelled order value and non-cancelled order value separately.
2. Which three product categories have the highest non-cancelled order value? Does that ranking change when using units requested? Explain why categories with different units may not be directly comparable by unit count.
3. Which branches have the highest cancellation rate?

   **counts may tell a different story and rate can be misleading.
4. What is the weighted discount rate for each category on non-cancelled orders?

   **averaging line percentages can be misleading, you can try to explain why.
5. Distinguish customer location from the fulfilling branch and does this impact the business in any way? **some customers do not have orders in 2025
6. Recommend at least two actions, you may attempt to call out the limitations of the dataset (what can you not establish?), if there is additional data that you would request to help with your analysis, you can name then in your report.

Main measures

- All order value = sum of net_order_value_ngn across all order statuses, including cancelled orders.
- Non-cancelled order value = the same amount excluding orders with status Cancelled. Includes Delivered, partially delivered and Pending orders. This is not invoiced sales, recognized revenue, cash or profit.
- Cancelled order value = value attached to orders with status Cancelled at the snapshot.
- Cancellation rate = cancelled orders divided by all orders placed. Count at order level or use distinct order IDs after joining lines.
- Weighted discount rate = total discount_value_ngn divided by total gross_order_value_ngn, on the same population. Multiply by 100 to display a percentage.
- Average non-cancelled order value = non-cancelled order value divided by the number of distinct non-cancelled orders. Do not divide by line count.

Expected deliverables

- One SQL file containing your queries, readable aliases and comments explaining important lines.
- One report page in a BI tool of your choice (Excel, Google Sheets, any tool you can use for visualization and reporting is acceptable) with no more than five visuals and clear labelling.
- One report page explaining at least two recommendations, supporting numbers, limitations and proposed follow-up measures.
- One Report Page explaining your methodology (include quality checks and all assumptions too if you have any).

Optional Work

- Compare weighted discount rates between channels, accounting for category mix and try to propose a policy around this.
- Create a reusable monthly summary SQL view and walk us through it.

Project 2 Delivery reliability

The decision

Kora's Operations Manager needs an investigation shortlist. Which branches or carriers deserve attention, and what evidence should be collected before changing service arrangements?

Assess delivery reliability for consignments attached to 2025 orders.

Your data

Start with deliveries and branches. Remember one delivery row is one consignment, not one order! An order can also have several consignments. The snapshot was taken on 31 December 2025.

Questions to answer

1. Analyze Delivered, Failed, In transit and Scheduled consignments. The idea is to keep failed and unresolved work visible.
2. Calculate on-time delivery rate among Delivered consignments, overall and by branch, carrier and any other dimension you deem important.
3. Among unresolved consignments, which were already overdue before the data snapshot was taken? **separating promises before, on and after 31 December 2025 may help here
4. Compare recorded shipping cost by branch and status. Explain why total cost and cost per delivered consignment answer different questions. **The cost of delivery on failed consignments is not reimbursed
5. Find the ten latest Delivered consignments by "days late". For SQLite use julianday(delivered_date)-julianday(promised_delivery_date); for SQL Server use DATEDIFF(day,promised_delivery_date,delivered_date).
6. Recommend two investigation priorities. Please consider the sample size, customer/product mix and unresolved work before blaming a carrier or branch.

Measures

- Delivered consignments = rows with status Delivered.
- On-time delivered consignments = Delivered rows with delivered_date on or before promised_delivery_date.
- On-time delivery rate = on-time delivered consignments divided by Delivered consignments. **Failed, In transit and Scheduled are not in this denominator but you can report them alongside.
- Unresolved consignments = In transit + Scheduled. **Failed consignments are a separate status.
- Overdue before cutoff = unresolved consignments with promise date before 2025-12-31.
- Total recorded shipping cost = sum shipping_cost_ngn across the stated population, including failures. **Making an inference about unrecorded future cost for unresolved or failed deliveries is not supported.
- Consignment delay = delivered date minus promise date for delivered consignment, snapshot date minus promise date for unresolved consignment.

Expected deliverables

- One SQL file containing your queries, readable aliases and comments explaining important lines.
- One report page in a BI tool of your choice (Excel, Google Sheets, any tool you can use for visualization and reporting is acceptable) with no more than five visuals and clear labelling.
- One report page explaining at least two recommendations, supporting numbers, limitations and proposed follow-up measures.
- One Report Page explaining your methodology (include quality checks and all assumptions too if you have any).

Optional extensions

- Produce an order-level table of consignment counts and recorded shipping cost using a CTE or a subquery.
- Join order value and delivery cost after independently aggregating both tables to one row per order. Demonstrate how joining the raw child tables can inflate your totals.

Files and control totals

Table	Expected rows
regions	6
branches	6
customers	1,100
products	54
orders	6,001
order_lines	15,491
deliveries	6,408

All-order net value is 17,713,266,033.00 NGN. This includes cancelled orders. It is an import control, not recognized revenue.

Software references

Use the official DB Browser for SQLite downloads, DB Browser documentation, SQL Server downloads and Microsoft SSMS connection guide. Software screens can change; follow the current official installer for your operating system.

Reuse and credit

You may analyse, modify and publish your SQL, dashboards and findings using this free training dataset with credit to CadencePlus Solutions™. Keep the fictional and synthetic labels. Do not present its values as real customer, employee or market data.

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